Social Media Marketing

Identifying, setting and measuring goals

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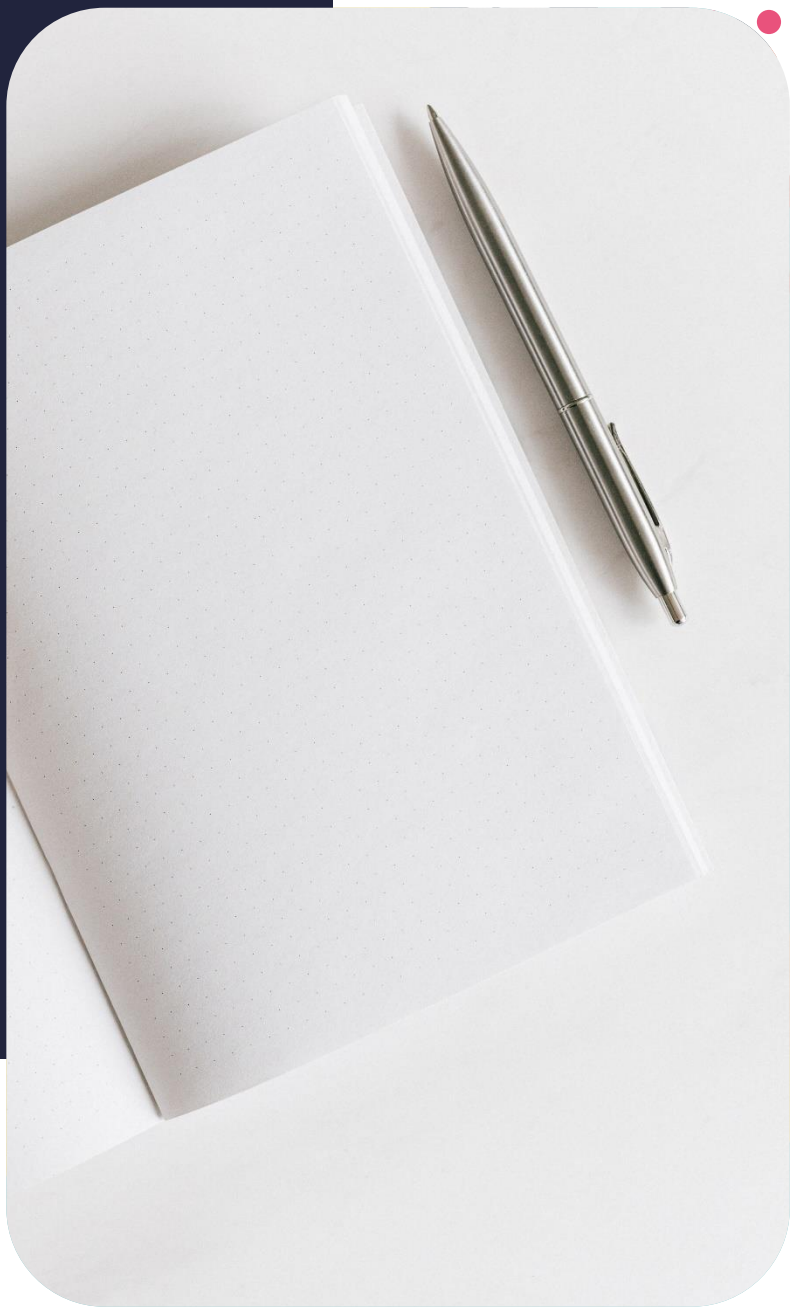

Lesson outcomes

- Identifying business goals
- Aligning social media goals
- Choosing relevant Key Performance Indicators
- Implementing goal strategies

Fun Fact

DID YOU KNOW:
56% of marketers think they are unable to track their social media revenue. Socialbakers.com

Social Media Strategy

A successful social media strategy entails:

- Knowing what you want to achieve overall for your business
- How your social media efforts can help you to achieve this
- Knowing what strategies you are going to use to reach these goals
- Measuring the success of these strategies
- Analysing and restrategising according to data

Business Goals

When identifying your business goals, ask yourself:

- What do I want to achieve?
- What do I want to conserve?
- What do I want to eliminate?
- What do I want to avoid?

Remember that social media marketing cannot help you to achieve all business goals.

Here is a list of the most common business goals that social media marketing can help you achieve;

- Brand awareness
- Brand engagement
- Community building
- Thought leadership
- Word-of-mouth
- Sales
- Customer service

Social Media Goals

Depending on what your business goal is, you will need to align this with the relevant social media goal. Here is a list of possible social media goals;

- Increase brand awareness
- Drive traffic to website
- Generate new leads
- Grow revenue
- Boost brand engagement
- Build a community around your business
- Provide social customer service
- Increase mentions in the press
- Listen to conversations about your brand

Key performance indicators

You then need to align the relevant key performance indicators according to your goals.

Remember that KPIs will be different for various goals and for various platforms!

Followers	Reach	Mentions	Shares
Retweets	Customer posts	Likes	Link/Post Clicks
Referrals	Comments	Replies	Frequency of engagment
Engagement per	Reviews	Suggestions	Website
Follower			Vistors/Traffic
Clicks	Subscriptions	Downloads	Contact Form Fill
Bounce rate	Checked-in	Tagged	Discount purchases
Return of investment	Revenue from social	Support queries	Average response time
First contact resolution Rate	Customer Satisfaction Score		

Social Media Metrics Formulas

Return on Investment
Profit - Investment / Investment X 100 = Return on Investment

Average response time
Time of first response - time of customer request = First response time (mins/hours/days)

First contact resolution rate
Number of support issues resolved on first contact / total number of first contact rate eligible support issues = First Contact Resolution Rate

Social Media Strategies

Network Strategy

This is a particularly useful strategy for those branching out into social media for the first time or who are starting over from scratch.

- Ensuring that you reach the right people - know your audience.
- Being on the right platform - are you using the right platforms based on your audience.
- Using the right people - have you leveraged every division of your business to embrace
- social media marketing and customer communications.
- Watching the competition - what platforms are they on, what content are they posting
- what kind of engagement are they receiving?

Access Strategy

This focuses on being findable on social media and is suited for companies who are just warming up to social media marketing.

- Make sure you are findable - this approach is geared more towards content marketing
- and search engine optimisation.
- Be flexible - offer services and content on the customers schedule not on yours and
- ensure that you use an omni-channel approach.
- Be fast - ensure that your response times and even your shipping times are fast.
- Keep it simple - keep your content and strategy simple and eliminate any sticking points
- for your customers.

Contact Strategy

This strategy helps you reach customers and create lasting connections with them.

- Social listening – use tools to track your online brand perception. Follow and learn from
- the conversations about your brand online.
- Be where the customer is – how easy is it for customers to find you and ask a question
- or report a problem?
- Join the conversation – respond to issues, answer questions and engage with users
- online and as quick as possible.
- Create a forum or group – create a place for customers to express their views and
- connect with each other.
- Add value – let the conversations you have online add value.

What does data mean?

Knowing your goals and having a clear idea of where to go and how to get there is all fair and well, but how do we take action from what we are measuring?

One metric on it's own may not give you a full picture, but considering multiple metrics in conjunction with each other will allow you to spot potential problems as well as opportunities.

Example 1

When measuring your brand awareness you will check your follower count, there are three potential situations that you may come across.

Situation 1: Follower count is repetitive.

Reason: Some growth is always good - if you want to boost your growth rate and you see an opportunity to do so then make the improvement. Otherwise leave it and continue to monitor your growth rate.

Situation 2: Your follower growth is out of control and growing exponentially month on month!

Reason: Awesome! But what did you do to get it there? Even if you are doing well, you still need to investigate how you got that result. If you can understand why something improved, then it can be repeated.

Situation 3: Your follower growth slows down drastically or completely stagnates.

Reason: This indicates that something may be affecting you follower growth rates. It could be internal factors, external factors or even it could be a seasonality and trends issue.

Disclaimer

You will not be able to gauge changes in metrics or the causes if you do not allow enough time to measure your metrics. This is why it is always good to develop a strategy, implement it over a year and measure it over that year so that you can start to identify natural trends - if the drop occurs at the same time every year then you know that it is simply an seasonality issue, if there are huge discrepancies between this year and last year then you need to take a closer look at your social platforms and content.

Example 2

The metrics that we would measure for our goal of building a community around our brand would be engagement metrics such as link clicks, likes, comments and shares.

Situation 1: Your post is receiving high link clicks but low shares.

Reason: This can indicate that your headline and image are enticing but your content is not.

Situation 2: Your shares are high, but your link clicks are low.

Reason: Maybe it makes people look good to share the content but doesn't necessarily interest them. Is this a problem for your business? Yes and No. If this user is your target customer and they are not reading your content it means that you are not producing content that it is useful to your customer then it's a problem but if that user isn't your target customer but their followers are then it isn't a problem.

How do we take action?

Social media data analysis is a lot like a science experiment - we create a hypothesis, test our hypothesis and then analyse the results.

The hypothesis

We have seen in the data that our link clicks are high but our shares are low – based on the theory that maybe the heading is enticing but that they were disappointed when they went onto the actual blog post/content.

Therefore our hypothesis then assumes that the content is possibly too simplistic, which is why the reader was disappointed and not willing to or was too embarrassed to share it.

The experiment

The experiment or the action that we take on our blog post then becomes to update the content to include more advanced information – but we want to keep the heading, image and post copy the same because that seems to be driving clicks and we only want to test one element at a time so that we can pinpoint why the click through is high but shares are low.

The results

One of two things will happen.

1. We will see further decline in shares which means that we will have to go back to the drawing board to work out what could be contributing to this and then hypothesizing and retesting.

2. Our click throughs and shares could go up and then we know that it was in fact that our follower was disappointed with the content or too embarrassed to share it.